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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Name .....
Section .....
ID .....

Faculty of Business Studies

BUC111
Business Communication 1

MTA Examination Makeup / Version: A
2024 – 2025 Spring / 23-April-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 6 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 1.5 hours

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
5- You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
6- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
7- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examina
8- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
9- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

Part	No. of questions	Time	Marks	Earned Marks	Signature
Part I	10	20 minutes	30		
Part II	6	10 minutes	18		
Part III	1	10 minutes	10		
Part IV	1	20 minutes	20		
Part V	1	30 minutes	22		
Total	19	90 minutes	100		

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Part I: Multiple-Choice Section: Choose the most appropriate answer. (30 marks)

1. What is the primary purpose of business communication?
   a) To entertain stakeholders
   b) To build relationships and exchange information
   c) To create confusion
   d) To maintain a casual environment
2. In the communication process, what does encoding refer to?
   a) Decoding the message
   b) Converting the message into a form suitable for transmission
   c) Receiving the message
   d) Responding to the sender
3. Which of the following is NOT a benefit of teamwork?
   a) Diverse perspectives
   b) Enhanced creativity
   c) Individual decision-making
   d) Improved problem-solving
4. What is the most effective way to resolve team conflicts?
   a) Avoid discussions
   b) Encourage open communication and focus on common goals
   c) Assign blame to one team member
   d) Use only email communication
5. Active listening involves:
   a) Interrupting to clarify doubts
   b) Focusing solely on the speaker's words
   c) Paying attention to both verbal and nonverbal cues
   d) Writing down every word spoken
6. What is cultural competency?
   a) Knowing a single culture deeply
   b) The ability to understand and adapt to different cultural contexts
   c) Avoiding interactions with people from other cultures
   d) Assuming all cultures are the same
7. High-context cultures rely heavily on:
   a) Written agreements
   b) Direct verbal communication
   c) Nonverbal cues and relationships
   d) Facts and statistics
8. Which term refers to adapting messages for international audiences?
   a) Localization
   b) Decoding
   c) Outsourcing
   d) Encoding
9. The first step in planning a business message is:
   a) Selecting the right communication channel
   b) Organizing the information
   c) Analyzing the situation and audience
   d) Writing the message
10. The "you" attitude in business communication emphasizes:
    a) The sender's needs and interests

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b) The receiver's needs and interests
c) A balance between sender and receiver interests
d) Making the message sound as professional as possible

Part II: Fill in the blanks: Use appropriate words from the box to fill in the blanks. **(18 marks)**

barriers – active – organizing – forming – explicit – intercultural – psychological safety

1. _____ communication refers to communication between individuals from different cultural backgrounds.
2. Effective teams encourage _____, where team members feel free to share ideas without judgment.
3. _____ listening is the practice of paying full attention to the speaker and responding thoughtfully.
4. Planning a message involves analyzing the audience, defining the purpose, and _____ the message's content.
5. Low-context cultures place a strong emphasis on _____ communication, where the message is clear.
6. The _____ stage of team development involves building trust and establishing norms.

Part III: What are the key steps to prepare for an effective meeting? **(10 marks)**

1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------
4. ----------
5. ----------

Part IV: Complete the table below by contrasting the conventional communication process model with the social communication model in terms of their characteristics. **(20 marks)**

Aspect	Conventional Communication Model	Social Communication Model
Communication Flow		
Audience Role		

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Feedback		
Message Control		
Channel		

Part V - Analyzing Communication Effectiveness: Read the case and the email below, then answer the questions that follow in a PARAGRAPH. (22 marks)

Background: This message is part of a group project communication scenario for a university assignment. The team consists of four members including Maria (the assumed coordinator). They recently held a meeting to discuss the project but failed to document or clarify specific task assignments, deadlines, or next steps.
Maria, attempting to follow up and ensure progress, sends this email to check on the team's status and confirm their responsibilities.

Subject: Group Project Progress

Hi Team,

Hope you're all doing well! I just wanted to check in about the progress of our project. I assume everything is on track, and we're all clear on our tasks. Let's make sure we have the draft ready soon, so Maria can review it before submission.
James, I think you're working on the introduction, right? Ravi, I believe you mentioned starting the main content already. Alice, you're covering the conclusion, correct? If there's any confusion, let's sort it out quickly.

Looking forward to seeing everyone's sections. Let's aim to finalize everything by the deadline.

Best,
Maria

Questions:

1. What is the general purpose of this message?
2. Is the email the most appropriate channel in this case? Why or why not?
3. What elements make the message ineffective? Justify your answer by giving three examples from the email.

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4. What should the writer do to make the message effective? Give at least 3 tips for improvement.

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